



FOOD FOR THOUGHT

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STORIES

9.86 seconds of precision

How diet, data, and discipline powered Kenneth Bednarek's **personal best** run in Philadelphia last month.

There's a number that echoes in my mind every time I watch Kenneth Bednarek, also known as Kung Fu Kenny, explode out of the blocks: 9.86. That's his personal best in the 100 metres. It's the kind of time that demands silence before applause. It stops conversation. It changes the narrative.

But the question remains: is that time the result of intense practice, precise nutrition, or just pure luck?

Let me tell you what I know from being on the inside. No one lands a 9.86 by chance. You don't roll out of bed, sip a protein shake, lace up your spikes, and touch that number.

9.86 is earned.

When Kenny joined my programme, he was already an Olympics silver medallist and a World Championship medallist. He had the accolades. He had the raw material. But he came with something more important — questions. He wanted to know how to go faster, how to recover better.

The first clue was in his blood. Inflammation markers hovered at borderline levels. There were signs of gut distress, including blood in his stool and occasional constipation. Most would have dismissed it. I did not. To me, that was noise in the system. And noise slows you down.

We eliminated gluten from day one. Within a week, he reported clearer skin, better bowel movements, no more bloating, and lighter energy. The inflammation dropped, and so did his internal stress. This wasn't just about avoiding a food group — it was about removing friction from the engine.

From there, we built what I call a performance ecosystem. Every gram of carbohydrate, every drop of liquid, every supplement is designed to perform a job. Training happens once or twice a day. Nutrition happens 24 hours a day. That's the difference.

Kenny trains in fasted states twice a week, but never

close to race day. His fasted runs in the morning push mitochondrial adaptation. We fine-tune when to feed, when to supplement, and when to hold back. The timing of his meals changes based on training loads and travel schedules.

Speaking of travel, our approach borders on military logistics. He flies with a customised supplement bag — double-locked, colour-coded, with customs clearance papers in place. He packs jerky, nuts, dried prunes, chamomile gummies, and sealed electrolyte sachets. Whether he's in Kenya or Paris, he never eats off-plan. That's not discipline. That's professionalism.

Race day? That's another beast.

The protocol is rehearsed weeks in advance. One hour before warm-up, Kenny takes a specific dose of pre-workout and BCAAs — not exceeding 10 grams. Then comes an isotonic sports drink or plain water. Thirty minutes out: a cold banana or caffeine slush. Beta-alanine only if he's not experiencing itchiness. We avoid surprises. We build a routine.

What about supplements? We made the full switch to Klean Athlete — BCAAs, creatine, ATP, multivitamins, glutamine. All WADA-compliant. All batch-tested. No mystery ingredients. We also use red light therapy, sauna, and cold plunges. Recovery is a full-time strategy.